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STATE AND COUNTY OFFICERS.

Members of Congress.

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CITY CHURCH DIRECTORY.

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Methodist Church.

[illegible]

Presbyterian Church.

[illegible]

Unitarian Church.

[illegible]

BUSINESS CARDS.

[illegible]

Organs, Melodeons, Violins,

[illegible]

ATTORNEY AT LAW.

[illegible]

ANN ARBOR MINERAL SPRINGS

[illegible]

DENTIST!

[illegible]

Written for the Courier.

To My Only Daughter on her Twenty-first Birthday.

[illegible]

Five Years Later.

[illegible]

I. M. CRANE'S ORATION.

The following is the Address delivered by the Hon. I. M. Crane, of Eaton Rapids, on the occasion of the unveiling of the Soldiers' Monument in the Fifth Ward of the city of Ann Arbor, on Decoration Day, May 30th, 1874:

LADIES AND GENTLEMEN,—You are convened here to-day upon an occasion the most solemn and impressive that has ever occurred in the history of your community.

Nine long years have passed away since the close of the Southern rebellion, but the scenes transpiring here to-day admonish us that our fellow-citizens who perished in that bloody conflict are still held by the people in grateful and vivid memory. Here, surrounded by the splendors of the opening season, by all that bespeaks plenty and contentment, you have assembled to unite in the ceremonies of erecting a monument to the heroic dead—a monument that, defying the thunders of tempests and ravages of time, shall stand through circling years, and bear to coming ages an evidence of the love and veneration of this people for their brave men who laid down their lives in defense of their country and the institutions of freedom. How grand, how impressive the scene! No words are given me to fitly describe it! [illegible]

FOREIGN CORRESPONDENCE.

Number LXXVIII.

TAIWAUFU, February 1, 1874.

Soon after my return from Kongana to this place, I went on board the German schooner "Fairlee," the captain of which had promised to drop me at the Pescadores. We sailed at two o'clock in the morning with very little wind, but by daylight it was blowing a gale and we were already driven down to the south of the Pescadores. After trying in vain to beat up against the wind, the captain turned about and ran for Formosa, the next morning finding us opposite Takow. Another day was taken up in beating up to Taiwaufu again, and the third day we again started for the Pescadores. This time we were fortunate enough to reach them, and just at night after beating up against the wind for several hours we got near enough to one of the islands so that a Chinese fishing boat came out and took me off and I landed at Sayson on Fisher's Island, among a lot of piratical fishermen, my only means of communication with them being through my Chinese boy, Onga. A foreigner seemed to be a great curiosity among them, and I was soon surrounded by a great share of the village. The promise of a little money led one of them to open his house to me, and after three days of sea-sickness and being tossed about the Formosan channel, it seemed very welcome, humble as it was. The next morning I opened a market, and though the wind and sea were still high these fishermen would dive through the waves and bring me bunches of living coral for a little cash each.

The most of the houses and walls are built of coral, and during the summer the people must be amphibious. After a days rest I took a stroll over the island and visited the little light-house on the south end. This is peculiarly a Chinese institution and unique. It is built solidly of granite from Amog, and is a pagoda of four stories and about thirty feet in height. In every face of each story there is an image of the goddess of sailors carved in the granite in *bas-relief*, and in the lower story there is a wooden image of the goddess with joss sticks continually burning before her. The light-house keeper is a priest, (Buddhist, I believe,) and is said to abstain from meat and other worldly pleasures. A pair of divining stones lay before the image, and the sailors are said to come here to pray for lucky voyages. The light that seems to be rather a secondary matter is a huge lamp fed with pea nut oil, but the glass around it was so dimmed by the clay that had blown upon it that I could hardly see the sea through it.

The island itself as well as the others about it, seems to be one mass of basaltic rock showing in columnar form in the cliffs along the coast. This basalt is gradually pulverized on the top of the island by the weather, forming a thin soil that hardly hides the rock beneath. During the north-east monsoon the islands are almost bare of vegetation, but many were plowing their little fields, and in one place a small footed woman was hobbling along holding plow and driving the buffalo with reins, though the wind was blowing so that it seemed as if it would pick us up and blow us into the sea. During the other monsoon nearly all the islands are planted to sweet potatoes and pea nuts, and many hogs and fowls are raised and sent to Amoy and Fachau. The inhabitants of all the islands number some eighty thousand, though from the deck of a vessel passing through them they appear to be barren and almost uninhabited. After passing a few days at Sayson and getting quite a collection of corals and shells, I took a native junk and sailed across to the harbor and town of Makang on the island of Ponghou, though the wind was still very high and we came near capsizing. Makang is quite a large town, and has the appearance of being fortified, though, as in most other cases of Chinese fortifying, the cannon were filled with rust and the carriages so rotten that they had to be propped to hold the weight of the guns. Makang has perhaps twenty thousand inhabitants, with a large market where most of the merchandise of Formosa and Amoy can be procured. I hired a room and was busy in collecting corals, fish, shells, and all the wonders of the seas, getting among the rest an immense polypus or devil fish, that spread ten feet, and is certainly large enough to be the brother of the one described by Victor Hugo in the "Toilers of the Sea." The islanders say that they are dangerous, and that they frequently draw pigs into the sea, and have in some cases destroyed children in the same way. Two fishermen attack them that they may help each other and by catching beneath them with a boat hook and tearing off an arm or two they cripple them so that they can get them into a boat, when they are helpless, though they live and move slowly about for several hours. They are an article of food and I tried eating them though they do not seem particularly pleasing to a civilized palate. My boy had been so careless as to leave my knife and fork behind at Taiwaufu, and several days I ate with a pen knife and a little Chinese spoon as I could not eat with chop sticks, and there was not a knife and fork on all the islands; but fortunately after I was nearly starved and had become pretty much savage in my method of eating, a Chinese gunboat came into the harbor, and this happened to have a knife and fork on board which I borrowed, and was again able to eat. There was a great feast about this time, and a sing-song at one of the temples, this consisting of a sort of open air theatre, a platform being built before the temple and a number of boys dressed as high ladies and gentlemen acted plays that I could tell but little about from the acting itself. Chinese plays seem to partake something of the sacred character of the old Greek plays, at least in the fact that they are often performed in or before the temples, and upon religious festivals. A large number of animals, life size, made by stretching colored paper over bamboo frames were also placed before the temple, a tiger with open mouth, a buffalo, a dragon, and stones were hung beneath them by strings to keep the wind from blowing them over. A large number of pretty mandarins were present and they all formed in line when the performance was over, and as the highest one got into his chair and went off the rest all bowed to the ground, and then the next in authority took his chair, and the remainder got down on their hands and knees and put their foreheads to the earth, and so on until it came to the more common herd who were content to take their chairs without so much ceremony. I made a trip to the further end of the island of Ponghou, which is the largest of the islands and some ten or twelve miles in length. It is nearly all under the plow, and we passed several houses that appeared to be farm houses, though, as elsewhere, the people here mostly live in villages. A few cabbages and turnips under the shelter of high walls were almost the only green things visible, the cold north-east trades having destroyed everything. At the north end of the island we saw a few orange trees that were raised by planting them under the shelter of a high wall of coral, and these were in bearing, though away from the shelter alpine plants would hardly have existed. We found a Christian in one of these villages at the north end of the island, who took us into his home and treated us very hospitably. He had been at Takow and belonged to Mr. Ritchies' mission.

From this end of the island we could see many small islands and rocks to the north and west, where no vessels but Chinese junks ever navigate, unless by accident. Many ships have been lost here and never heard of. The Chinese islanders, genuine wreckers and pirates by nature, would think it foolish to save human life while there was valuable cargo floating about. I saw something of this practical tendency while at Sayson. I saw many men rushing to their boats one day with hammers and axes, and other such implements, and inquiring the cause, found the look-out perched on one of the higher points of the island had brought word that there was a junk upon the rocks with men and cargo in the water, and they were gathering in their funny little boats from all directions like vultures to the carrion.

After nearly two weeks of life upon these islands, I got my collections, consisting of nearly half a ton of coral of nearly thirty species, a couple of bushels of shells, and a twelve gallon case of fish with several hundred specimens on board a little junk bound for Taiwaufu, and we set sail at two o'clock in the morning and by daylight we were out of sight of the low, flat islands of the Pescadores, while the high, central range of mountains of Formosa, showed in front, covered for fifty or sixty miles of its length with snow. We were rolling and pitching well, and I cramped in a little cabin too small to sit upright or lie at full length in, though it was the best the craft afforded, and the captain staid on deck to give me room. A little old besmoked and begrimmed idol was on a shelf above me and a couple of joss sticks before it. Now and then one of the sailors would come down and light a new joss stick and fold his hands and chin-chin the idol, and then go up to his work again. Chinese junks are very strongly built, and they are divided by thick plank partitions, into many narrow compartments, and these are all made water tight so that a junk will float when it appears to be nearly to pieces. They use a cement for caulking the seams that makes pitch and turpentine useless. This is made of quick lime and oil, and is very durable, and might be made use of by more civilized nations. The junks all have a pair of huge eyes painted upon the prow that the vessel may not run into danger. The masts have no rigging to support them, and the greater share of losses seem to arise from the masts being broken and the vessels drifting helpless to sea. The sails are huge mat ones, and are raised by means of a rude windlass. We were in sight of the island of Anpine, and the old Dutch fort, Zelandia, at noon, and at three o'clock we crossed the bar and the sail was lowered, and the men poled the vessel to its anchorage near the shore, and I had concluded my trip to the Pescadores.

J. B. STEERE.

A Legend of the Mohawk Valley.

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